

EDUC 260A/PUB PLC 276A: Introduction to Programming and Data Management

Software to install before first class meeting

Please skim through all of the instructions before getting start.

1. Create a GitHub account

- We will conduct all class-related discussions on this version control system instead of using Canvas. We will also use GitHub to collaborate on weekly problem sets, send announcements, and ask questions.
- Follow these instructions to set up an account.
 - Go to <https://github.com/> and sign up for GitHub. When creating your account, use an email address that you regularly access and expect to retain. GitHub will use this address for account verification, security notifications, and repository invitations. Also, please consider including your first and/or last name as part of your username so that we can easily identify your work, questions, and comments.
 - Once you have successfully created a GitHub account, you will receive an email to verify your account. Follow the instructions on the email.
 - Plug in your name and Github username in this [google form](#).

2. Install R

Note: if you have already installed R and R studio, you don't need to re-install, but if compatibility issues arise later in the quarter, you may have to re-install/update.

- Go to <https://cran.r-project.org/>

- Select “Download R for Windows”
 - Click “install R for the first time”
 - Click “Download R 4.6.1 for Windows”
- Select “Download R for macOS”
 - Click either “R-4.6.1-arm64.pkg” or “R-4.6.1-x86_64.pkg” depending on the version of your Mac.

3. Install RStudio

- Go to <https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop/>
- Scroll to the bottom of the page
- Select “RStudio-2026.08.2-200.exe” for Windows users
- Select “RStudio-2026.08.2-200.dmg” for Mac users

Note: The newest Rstudio works on macOS 14 or later. If you have issues installing and your Mac has an older operating system, you may need to install an older version of RStudio [here](#).

Disclaimer: We will do our best in assisting with any issues regardless if it’s a Mac or Windows.